

NEW WORLD ORDER

A quick look at how things will change for the countries of the world if China was walled off

The world has already lived through a China-less phase of rapid technological advancement. It was the US, Japan and Germany that led the way before, and post China it will be someone else's turn.

In this article we will move on in time in our hypothetical scenario, to 2030, where the world has gone through the shock and come out on the other side. Things are getting better, and other countries have picked up the slack in most areas that were rocked. So what does the world look like now?

POINT INSERTION

You've been dropped into the world in February 2030, with the memorial service for the million lives lost to COVID-19 just a decade ago. You head to your favourite news source to find out what's happening in the world, and this is what you find...

Manufacturing: China has been replaced by India, Brazil, Vietnam and Nigeria, in that order. Japan and South Korea also ramped up production, and are running at peak capacity. Prices have come down significantly as compared to 2020 to 2022 levels, but is still a little higher than 2019 levels. Even the US and Germany have restarted a lot of their old factories for production of cars, as Japan has been totally geared towards information technology. All Japanese car brands are now headquartered in the US and Germany, though it is completely an automated process, without a human ever touching a car.

Medicine: After COVID-19 was finally overcome with a vaccine that was developed and manufactured in record time in India, we've become the pharmacists of the world. Almost all international pharma brands have a large presence in India, and we account for 60% of the world's drug manufacturing. We're also the world's doctors and the world's laboratory, as a record number of doctors graduated the 2026 batch – more than in all of the world put together! India developed top notch medical facilities that rival the best, and has more papers published in the Lancet than all other countries combined. Medical tourism is the number one reason for people visiting India.

IT: Vietnam, Thailand and the Philippines have more electronics and computer engineers per capita than other nations thanks to their governments' waiver of fees for engineering colleges and multi-billion dollar investment in engineering education. This one move, which those three governments all

took together, gave them an unbeatable edge over all other countries, and they replaced China collectively for all ICB and component manufacturing. Taiwan, Korea and Singapore became the first countries to have 3 nm fabs, and account for all of the processor manufacturing of the world.

Mining: India, Australia, Brazil and Myanmar really stepped up their mining of rare earth elements to make up for the huge shortfall that was experienced in 2020. Surprisingly the US and Russia did not step up their mining game, instead choosing to use their mining output internally within their own countries. Both countries have conservative governments who are turning more insular in many ways.

Assembling: India and Brazil stepped up their assembly lines for a lot of technology products, however Nigeria was a surprise entrant into the game in late 2024, and in just 6 years has cornered the market on smartphone assembling, at prices that are unbeatable by the rest of the world. This has resulted in a total brain drain of engineers from all other African nations, all seeking residence in Nigeria. The country's GDP tripled in just 6 years, which is unprecedented in modern history!

Agriculture: India, Brazil, Canada, US, Australia and Russia have emerged as the world's food sources, with India way ahead in the lead. While Brazil and Australia took up the slack in the production of meats for the world that China left behind, India ramped up exports of rice, vegetables and milk to never before seen levels. While the US produces a lot of wheat, soy and meat, it also consumes the most per capita, and has negligible exports.



There is a clear negative sentiment against China. We have received requests for supply from India. If we play our cards right, we could double our exports (of electronic products) in three years' time

– Amrit Manwani, President, Electronic Industries Association of India
<https://digit.in/shiftin>

